

Project KOM — Governance & Public Policy Strategy

INSTITUTIONAL EXECUTION, PILOT SETUP & REGULATORY BLUEPRINT

GOOGLE FMC 2026
FINALIST

FOUNDER & SYSTEM ARCHITECT: Ridhi Jain
PUBLIC POLICY & GOVERNANCE LEAD: [Vanshika Sharma](#) (Co-Presenter)
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Strategic Objective: Transform Project KOM from a software-driven hackathon concept into an approved, legally sound, zero-capex municipal civic initiative ready for immediate pilot implementation across Delhi-NCR.

01 EXECUTIVE INTRODUCTION & LEADERSHIP SYNERGY

When presenting before technical and venture judges at the Grand Finale (IIT Delhi, October 1, 2026), projects that rely solely on software demos are frequently scrutinized on civic viability, regulatory compliance, and municipal permission bottlenecks.

Project KOM bridges this gap through a complementary dual-leadership structure that pairs deeply engineered technology with specialized public policy navigation:

Domain	Ridhi Jain (Founder & System Architect)	Vanshika Sharma (Public Policy & Governance Lead)
Primary Responsibility	Core System Architecture & Gemini AI Engine	Civic Machinery, Regulatory Compliance & Scaling Policy
Core Deliverables	- Live Google Gemini 2.5 Flash evaluation API - Commuter mobile app with Web Speech voice dictation - Blind ATS corporate recruitment dashboard	- Municipal MoU & Regulatory Sandbox filings - National Education Policy (NEP 2020) alignment - DPDP Act 2023 privacy governance & ULB coordination
Grand Finale Stage Role	Live Product Demonstration & Engineering Rigor	Civic Roadmap, Municipal Feasibility & Policy Defense

02 THE PUBLIC POLICY FOUNDATION: WHY HER ROLE IS CRUCIAL

Vanshika Sharma’s background in Public Policy (MPP) and institutional governance brings three indispensable strategic assets to Project KOM:

CRITERION 1: INSTITUTIONAL & ACADEMIC AUTHORITY

Ground-Level Presence at Finale Venue (IIT Delhi)

Having an institutional connection to IIT Delhi elevates the team's presentation from an external visiting delegation to a locally anchored initiative. It provides immediate stage credibility when addressing judges and municipal mentors.

CRITERION 2: POLICY SCHEME MAPPING

Aligning KOM with National Priorities (NEP 2020 & Smart Cities)

Bureaucrats and municipal commissioners do not pass new laws for individual startups. Vanshika maps KOM directly into existing national targets:

- **National Education Policy (NEP 2020):** Meets the mandate for experiential problem-solving and equitable access to industry challenges for Tier-2/Tier-3 students.
- **Smart Cities Mission:** Provides urban local bodies with measurable community skilling and ambient infrastructure upgrades that boost their annual Smart City scorecard.

CRITERION 3: REGULATORY COMPLIANCE

Data Governance under the DPDP Act 2023

Public infrastructure projects handle sensitive student data. Vanshika structures KOM's compliance with India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDP Act 2023): candidate submissions remain completely anonymized at the edge, masking college names and personal contact details until mutual recruiter opt-in is established.

03 STEP-BY-STEP PILOT INSTALLATION & GOVERNMENT ROADMAP

To bypass long municipal red tape and multi-year tender cycles, Project KOM follows a structured 3-phase rollout strategy:

PHASE 1: Pure Software Engine in Pre-Approved Public Spaces (Months 1-3) ↳ Deployed inside Municipal Libraries & Public Computer Labs (e.g. DSEU/Community Reading Rooms). ↳ Leverages existing government IT infrastructure with ZERO street construction permits required. ↳ Target Milestone: 500 verified student submissions and initial employer hiring validation. | ▼ PHASE 2: Startup India Regulatory Sandbox Pilot (Months 4-6) ↳ Filed under the State Innovation Sandbox Guidelines for greenfield technology pilots. ↳ Secures 90-day trial sign-off from the City Municipal Commissioner via a single administrative order. ↳ Target Milestone: 50 transit screen units deployed along one high-footfall educational corridor. | ▼ PHASE 3: Piggybacking on Commercial Advertising Concessions (Months 7-12) ↳ Partner with private media concessionaires who already own long-term bus shelter maintenance contracts. ↳ Replace static paper hoardings with low-power reflective e-paper screens at zero capex to city treasury. ↳ Self-funded via corporate employer subscription fees (₹14,200/hire vs ₹1,85,000 standard campus cost).

04 ANSWERS TO THE 4 HARDEST GOVERNMENT & POLICY QUERIES

QUERY 01

"Municipal tender processes take 12–18 months. How can a startup deploy quickly?"

The Strategy: We completely bypass commercial bidding tenders during Phase 1 & 2. By leveraging the State Regulatory Sandbox provisions under the Startup India mission, Urban Local Bodies (ULBs) can authorize a 90-day experimental pilot in one educational zone using a simple administrative sanction.

QUERY 02

"Where does the capex come from for street screens and maintenance?"

The Strategy: Municipal corporations do not pay for the hardware. We co-locate with private outdoor advertising concessionaires who already hold long-term maintenance contracts for transit shelters. We upgrade their static slots to energy-efficient e-paper at zero cost to the municipality, funded by corporate hiring subscriptions.

QUERY 03

"How do you address public liability and data privacy on public screens?"

The Strategy: The physical display operates as a unidirectional broadcast screen that never collects or stores personal data. Commuter answers are submitted on personal mobile devices with air-gapped anonymization. All raw data is scrubbed and purged within 24 hours in full compliance with the DPDP Act 2023.

QUERY 04

"Why would transit authorities care about student employment?"

The Strategy: Transit authorities face significant pressure to demonstrate civic value beyond basic transportation. KOM converts unproductive dwell time (18.2 min daily average) into measurable skilling, directly contributing to the city's Smart Cities Mission annual assessment without requiring any municipal budget.

05 IMMEDIATE PILOT EXECUTION CHECKLIST (DELHI-NCR CORRIDOR)

Milestone	Target Partner / Agency	Output Deliverable
1. Institutional Lab Setup	Delhi Public Library & DSEU Campus Labs	Software-only pilot access across 20 reading centers.
2. Sandbox Application	Department of Information Technology / Urban Local Body	90-day regulatory sandbox pilot order for Noida-Delhi transit corridor.

Milestone	Target Partner / Agency	Output Deliverable
3. Concessionaire MoU	Private Outdoor Transit Advertising Concessionaire	Standardized tri-partite MoU for 50 shelter e-paper screen retrofits.
4. Employer Onboarding	Tier-1 Supply Chain, Logistics & Healthcare Enterprise Partners	3 active corporate challenges with guaranteed review SLAs for top candidates.